

QUANTUM

Quantum physics began as an attempt by scientists to explain a number of apparently separate puzzles in early 20th-century physics. These puzzles affected the nature of light emitted by objects heated to different temperatures, the internal structure of the atom, and the interaction between light and matter. Together, they led to the realization that electromagnetic waves are emitted and delivered in small, discrete packets of energy known as photons, and hinted at deeper mysteries in the behavior of subatomic particles.